

Our New Operations System — A Simple Guide

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Tech Shipping is building its own software to handle inquiries, quotations and deliveries faster, with less typing and fewer mistakes. This guide explains what is changing, in plain words.

Why we are doing this

Our aim: send a client a correct quotation within 30 minutes of receiving their list, instead of hours or days.

Today, almost everything is done by hand. We read supply lists on WhatsApp, type them into Excel, search for vendors from scratch, calculate commission, GST and port charges by hand, and track deliveries over the phone. This takes time, and small mistakes in typing or calculation can cost us money or a client.

The new system takes over the typing, searching and calculating. That leaves our team free to do what matters most: finding good vendors, talking to clients, and closing deals.

How work changes: before and after

Task	Today	With the new system
Receiving the supply list	Read on the co-founder's phone, forwarded around	Every list lands in one shared screen automatically
Writing down the items	Typed into Excel by hand	The system reads the list, even photos, and fills it in; we check it
Finding vendors	Fresh internet search and calls every time	The system shows vendors we used before and what they charged
Working out the price	Calculator and Excel	Commission, GST and port charges added automatically

Task	Today	With the new system
Sending the quotation	Made and sent by hand	A clean, branded quotation sent in one click
Discounts and negotiation	Lost in chats and calls	Every change recorded, with a warning if we go too low
Ordering from vendors	Separate messages and calls	Purchase orders made from the approved quotation
Delivery	Followed up by phone	Everyone can see if it is packed, sent or delivered
Billing and payment	Done separately	Bill made from the final quotation; unpaid bills flagged

It also handles the everyday situations we deal with:

- A client adds items later: the new message joins the same inquiry.
- An item we've never sold: we add it once; a manager sets its GST.
- An item we can't get: shown as "Not available" or offered as a substitute.
- A client accepts only some items: we order, deliver and bill only those.
- A client and vendor use different units (KG vs drum): the system converts.
- An advance payment before we buy: a proforma invoice, then the advance is adjusted in the final bill.
- Short delivery or returned goods: recorded, with a credit note if needed.
- Vendor bills and payments: recorded, so we see the real profit on every order.
- Lists in Hindi, Marathi or mixed language: the system reads these too.

What the system will do

Think of it as a very organised new colleague who never forgets anything and never gets tired.

1. **Reads every inquiry.** When a master sends a list on WhatsApp or email, the system reads it, including photos of handwritten lists, and writes each item neatly: name, size, quantity.
2. **Remembers every product.** It knows that "SS bolt 12mm" and "steel bolt M12" are the same thing, and which GST rate applies to it.

3. **Remembers every vendor.** Who sells what, what they charged last time, how fast they delivered, and whether there were complaints.
4. **Prepares the quotation.** It adds our commission, the right GST for each item, and the port charges for that port, then makes a clean quotation with our company name and logo.
5. **Keeps track of negotiation.** Every revised price and discount is saved, so nothing is forgotten.
6. **Follows each order to the ship.** From buying from the vendor, to packing, to tempo or train, to delivery on board.
7. **Makes the bill.** It prepares the GST invoice and reminds us of unpaid bills.
8. **Answers questions (later, optional).** Once enough records build up, anyone will be able to type a question like "What did we pay for paint last month?" and get the answer straight away.

After several months of use, it may also help us predict what clients will need next. That comes later, once we have enough history.

WhatsApp: what changes

For clients, nothing changes. They keep messaging the same number they use today.

For us:

- The co-founder's WhatsApp number will be switched to a **WhatsApp Business** account. His chats stay, and he can keep using it on his phone as normal.
- The same number will also be connected to our new system, so every client message is saved there automatically.
- The system can send the quotation, delivery updates and payment reminders on WhatsApp, but **only when one of us clicks Send**. An automatic "we've received your list" reply will be switched on only after it has been tested.
- **All price discussions and negotiation stay with our team.** The system never agrees to prices or discounts on its own.

Please note:

- The system cannot read WhatsApp **groups**. If a client sends a list in a group, ask them to send it directly to the number as well.
- Old chats stay on the phone. The system saves only new messages from the day it is switched on.

- Personal chats should gradually move to a separate personal number, since this number becomes the company's.

What stays in our hands

The system does the paperwork. People make the decisions. Nothing reaches a client or vendor without a person approving it.

- **Checking the list:** we confirm the items the system read are correct.
- **Choosing vendors:** the system suggests; we decide.
- **Setting commission:** we choose the percentage for each deal.
- **Approving quotations:** every quotation is checked before it is sent.
- **Negotiation and discounts:** handled by our team, as always.
- **Relationships:** calls, visits and trust with masters and vendors remain our work.

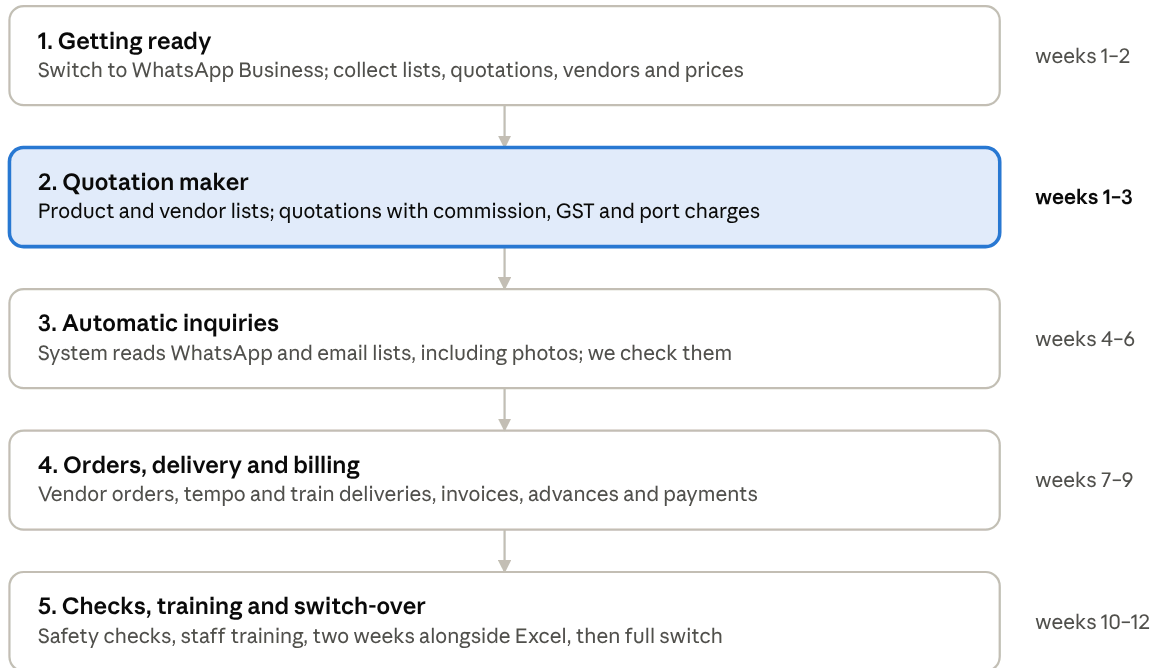
This system is here to support the team, not to replace anyone. It removes the boring, repetitive work so each of us can handle more clients, faster.

Privacy: our costs, vendor prices and commission will be visible only to the people who need them. Clients see only the final price and GST.

When it arrives

The system arrives in five stages over about three months, so the team can learn one part at a time.

Automatic quotations, the first big win, arrive in about 3 weeks



rollout · 5 stages over about 3 months

Each stage is tested with real inquiries before the next one starts. For the first two weeks after it is ready, we will use it alongside Excel, so nothing is missed. Times are estimates and may shift.

What we need from you

The system is only as good as the information we give it. Before building starts, please help collect:

- ☐ 20 real supply lists from clients (WhatsApp screenshots or exports), and for each one, the correct list of items and quantities. This is how we check the system reads lists accurately. Client names and numbers will be removed.
- ☐ 10 vendor quotations we received
- ☐ 5 past quotations we sent
- ☐ Our list of vendors with phone numbers, emails and what they supply
- ☐ Port charges we usually add for each port
- ☐ GST rates we use for common items (to be checked with our CA)
- ☐ Ideas: what wastes the most time in your day?

Common questions

Will I lose my job? No. The system handles repetitive typing and calculation so the team can serve more clients. People still run the business.

Do I need computer skills? Only basic ones. The screens will be simple, in plain English, and will work on a laptop or phone. Everyone will get training.

What if the system makes a mistake? Every list and every quotation is checked by a person before it goes out, so mistakes are caught early.

Will clients notice a difference? Yes, in a good way: faster replies, neater quotations, and delivery updates on WhatsApp.

Who do I ask for help? Sunil Bangare, who is leading this project.